SkillNavora

MODULE 2 HANDBOOK

Module 2: Salesforce Ecosystem and Marketing Cloud Introduction

5 sections, 49 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 2: Salesforce Ecosystem and Marketing Cloud Introduction

Level: Beginner. Where Marketing Cloud fits among the Salesforce clouds, and how the Engagement product, its business units and its studios are organised.

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Detailed lessons

Module 2

2.1 The Salesforce clouds

WHAT IS IT?

> Salesforce sells several clouds: Sales Cloud (sales), Service Cloud (support), Marketing Cloud (marketing), Experience Cloud (portals), Data Cloud (unified customer data), Commerce Cloud (e-commerce) and the Salesforce Platform used to build apps.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Projects often connect Marketing Cloud to Sales or Service Cloud data. Knowing each cloud's job tells you where the data should come from.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Name the cloud that owns the customer's order history, support tickets and marketing consent in a typical company.
2. Decide which cloud is the system of record for each.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A retailer keeps orders in Commerce Cloud, support cases in Service Cloud, and sends campaigns from Marketing Cloud.

COMMON ERRORS

Treating Marketing Cloud as the master customer database when the CRM should own it.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

Where does Marketing Cloud fit in the Salesforce ecosystem?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write a one-paragraph description of each cloud and its main data.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce: product overview

Module 2

2.2 Marketing Cloud Engagement and related products (naming and licensing)

WHAT IS IT?

> Marketing Cloud Engagement is the product for email, mobile, journeys and automation. Other Salesforce marketing products include Marketing Cloud Personalization, Marketing Cloud Intelligence and editions such as Growth and Advanced. Feature availability depends on the edition and the licence on your account.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Product names and editions change. Promising a feature that your edition lacks causes project failure.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Confirm the product name and edition on the Salesforce product pages.
2. Check the account's licensed features in Setup before designing a solution.
3. Record which features need a specific licence.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A proposal that needs real-time web personalisation must confirm the Personalization product is licensed, not assume Engagement includes it.

Licence and edition: Verify current editions and licences on Salesforce pages before you commit to a design.

COMMON ERRORS

Assuming every SFMC account has the same features.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

How would you confirm what your account can do?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Make a table of five features and the product or edition that provides each, verified on official pages.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Marketing Cloud product pages

2.1 Salesforce Fundamentals: every topic explained

What is Salesforce?. Salesforce is a cloud CRM company whose products manage sales, service, marketing, commerce and customer data.

Salesforce ecosystem. The products, platform, partner apps (AppExchange), community and consultants around Salesforce.

CRM architecture. Salesforce uses a multi-tenant cloud with a metadata-driven platform: objects, fields, automation and security model, used through apps and APIs.

Salesforce clouds. The product families: Sales, Service, Marketing, Experience, Commerce, Data Cloud and more, each licensed separately.

Sales Cloud. Manages leads, accounts, contacts, opportunities and forecasts for sales teams.

Service Cloud. Manages cases, knowledge and service channels for support teams.

Marketing Cloud. Salesforce's marketing products, including Marketing Cloud Engagement for email, mobile, journeys and automation.

Experience Cloud. Builds portals and sites for customers, partners and communities on Salesforce data.

Data Cloud. Unifies customer data from many sources into profiles for segmentation, insights and activation.

Commerce Cloud. Runs B2C and B2B e-commerce storefronts.

Salesforce Platform. The underlying platform for building custom objects, apps, automation and integrations.

2.2 Marketing Cloud Fundamentals: every topic explained

What is Salesforce Marketing Cloud?. A Salesforce family of products for digital marketing. Developers and administrators usually mean Marketing Cloud Engagement when they say SFMC.

Marketing Cloud Engagement. The core product for email, mobile, Journey Builder, Automation Studio, Contact Builder and CloudPages.

Marketing Cloud Growth. A Salesforce marketing edition built on the core Salesforce platform and Data Cloud, aimed at simpler marketing needs. Check current scope on Salesforce's pages.

Marketing Cloud Advanced. A higher Salesforce marketing edition with more advanced capabilities, also built on the platform. Check current scope and licensing.

Marketing Cloud Personalization. The real-time web and app personalisation product, formerly called Interaction Studio.

Marketing Cloud Intelligence. Cross-channel marketing analytics and reporting, formerly known as Datorama.

Marketing Cloud architecture. Engagement is a separate multi-tenant system with its own accounts, business units, data extensions and APIs, connected to Salesforce through connectors.

Business units. Separate units inside an Engagement account, each with its own sending settings, users, data and assets.

Enterprise accounts. The top-level account type that holds a parent business unit and its child business units.

MID and account structure. The MID (member ID) is the numeric ID of each business unit and is used in APIs, support and configuration.

2.3 SFMC Architecture: every topic explained

Tenant architecture. Engagement runs on Salesforce-managed infrastructure (stacks); each customer account is a tenant with its own data.

Enterprise and child business units. The parent (enterprise) business unit can share data and assets down to child business units.

Account structure. How the enterprise, business units, users and roles are arranged.

Subscriber model. The Email Studio model of subscribers, lists and statuses keyed by subscriber key.

Contact model. The Contact Builder model that unifies a person across channels by contact key.

Data model. Data extensions, data views and relationships that hold the customer, transaction and engagement data.

Shared data extensions. Data extensions created in the shared folder of the parent business unit and made available to child units.

Roles and permissions. Roles group permissions; users get roles per business unit to control what they can see and do.

Multi-business-unit implementation. Designs where several brands or countries run in separate business units with shared parts, governed centrally.

2.4 Marketing Cloud Components: every topic explained

Email Studio. Creates, sends and tracks email; manages subscribers, lists and sends.

Content Builder. The content library for emails, templates, blocks and images across channels.

Journey Builder. Builds multi-step, multi-channel customer journeys triggered by events or data.

Automation Studio. Schedules and runs data work: SQL queries, imports, exports, file transfers and sends.

Contact Builder. Manages contacts, data extensions, relationships (Data Designer) and imports.

Mobile Studio. SMS (MobileConnect) and app push (MobilePush) messaging.

CloudPages. Hosted landing pages, forms and microsites using HTML and AMPscript.

Analytics. Reports and analytics such as Analytics Builder and tracking reports.

Intelligence. Marketing Cloud Intelligence for cross-channel reporting (separate licence).

2.5 Understanding the SFMC Interface: every topic explained

Login and navigation. Log in with your username and multi-factor authentication, then choose the business unit to work in.

Application switcher. The menu that switches between studios and builders.

Marketing Cloud dashboard. The landing view after login, with shortcuts and recent items.

Setup. Setup holds account, user, security and channel settings.

Administration. Administrative tasks: users, roles, business units, sender profiles and account settings.

Email Studio navigation. Email Studio menus: Content, Subscribers, Interactions, Tracking, Admin.

Automation Studio navigation. Automation Studio: overview of automations, activities and run history.

Journey Builder navigation. Journey Builder: journeys list, canvas, entry sources and activity panel.

Content Builder navigation. Content Builder: folders, assets, blocks and templates.

Contact Builder navigation. Contact Builder: All Contacts, Data Designer, Data Extensions and Imports.